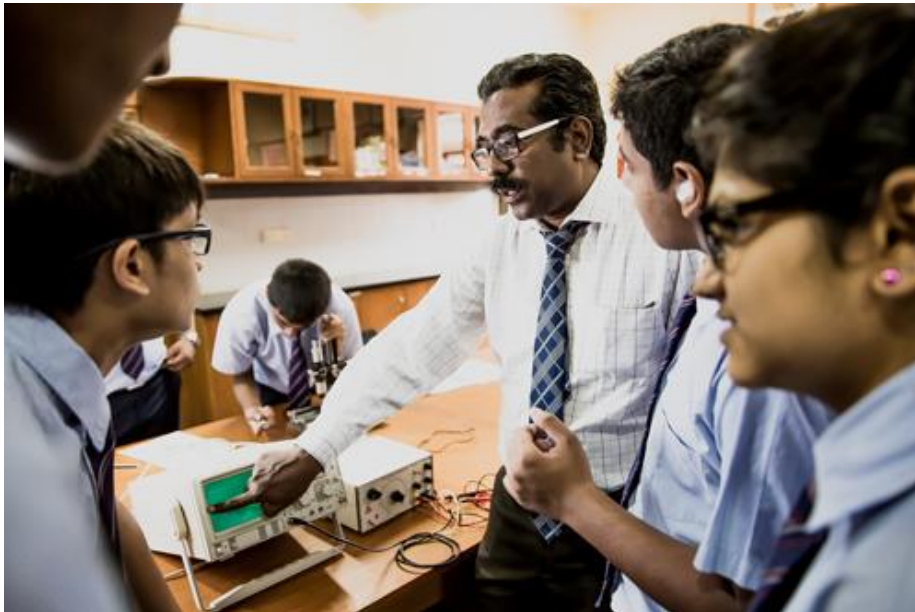


Weekly Newsletter 2026-W02

Building critical thinking among students



10 January 2026

Introduction

In today's fast-changing world, students need more than textbook knowledge they need the ability to think clearly, question deeply, and make smart decisions. Critical thinking helps students understand ideas, analyze information, and apply learning to real-life situations.

As teachers, we play a key role in shaping these skills. By encouraging curiosity, discussion, and reflection, we can help students become independent thinkers and confident learners. This newsletter shares simple, practical strategies to build critical thinking in everyday classrooms.

Why Critical Thinking Is Important

Critical thinking helps students to:

- Understand concepts deeply, not just memorize 
- Ask meaningful questions 
- Solve problems creatively 
- Express ideas clearly 
- Make logical and informed decisions 

These skills prepare students for academics, careers, and life.

Effective Strategies to Build Critical Thinking

1. Ask Open-Ended Questions

Use questions that encourage thinking:

- “Why do you think this happened?”
- “What could be another solution?”
- “What would you do differently?”

This pushes students to explain *how* and *why*, not just answer.

2. Encourage Classroom Discussions

Group discussions allow students to:

- Listen to different viewpoints
- Share opinions
- Think critically about ideas

Discussions build confidence and reasoning skills.

3. Connect Learning to Real Life

Relate lessons to everyday situations:

- Maths: budgeting or shopping
- Science: environmental issues

- Social Studies: community problems

Real-life connections make thinking meaningful.

4. Use Think–Pair–Share

- Think individually
- Discuss with a partner
- Share with the class

This supports reflection and participation from all students.

More Classroom Practices That Help

1. Encourage Curiosity

Welcome questions even challenging ones.
A curious classroom is a thinking classroom.

2. Ask Students to Explain Their Thinking

Instead of just answers, ask:

- “How did you arrive at this?”
- “What steps did you follow?”

This improves clarity and reasoning.

7. Use Debates and Role Play

- Debates help students see multiple perspectives
- Role play builds empathy and analytical thinking

Learning becomes active and engaging.

8. Practice Reflection

End lessons with reflection:

- “What did you learn today?”
- “What was difficult?”

Reflection deepens understanding and self-awareness.

Did You Know?

 Studies show that students who practice critical thinking regularly perform better academically and develop stronger problem-solving and decision-making skills.

Here are some reference links to empower your knowledge and deepen your understanding

- [Fostering and assessing student critical thinking: From theory to teaching practice - Vincent-Lancrin - 2023 - European Journal of Education - Wiley Online Library](#)
- [15 Critical Thinking Activities For Students - Educationise](#)

Watch this quick video to grasp the concept -

[5 tips to improve your critical thinking - Samantha Agoos](#)

Latest Education Update

IGNOU to host a mega job fair in New Delhi

Indira Gandhi National Open University (IGNOU) is organizing a large job fair on January 12, 2026 in collaboration with the Confederation of Indian Industry. The fair will connect students and alumni with employers in sectors such as aviation, customer service, technology, hospitality, and more offering on-spot interviews and free registration. [The Times of India](#)

Inspirational Teachers' Story



Baljinder Singh Brar

Baljinder Singh Brar, Vice-Principal and English Lecturer at Government Higher Secondary School, Chak 4JJ in Sriganganagar, Rajasthan, has dedicated his career to uplifting students and preserving cultural identity. Though his subject expertise lies in English, he actively promoted Punjabi language by providing books and magazines to students, ensuring that their heritage remained strong alongside modern education. He also supported underprivileged learners by distributing free stationery and competitive exam materials, helping them overcome financial barriers to education. His efforts extended beyond academics, as he contributed to initiatives like the PM Nutrition Scheme, ensuring students had access to healthy meals that improved attendance and learning outcomes. His commitment to education and community welfare earned him national recognition. On Teacher's Day, 5 September 2024, President Droupadi Murmu honored him with the prestigious National Teacher Award. Brar's work demonstrates how a teacher's role goes far beyond classroom instruction he blended subject expertise with cultural preservation, social responsibility, and student empowerment. His story stands as an inspiration for educators across India, showing that true teaching is about shaping lives and communities, not just delivering lessons.

About Us

At Teachinghood, we believe great schools are built by great teachers. That's why our mission is to simplify and strengthen the teacher hiring journey for both educators and institutions. Our platform connects schools with skilled, passionate teachers by offering a streamlined, transparent, and efficient recruitment process. Teachers gain easy access to opportunities that match their strengths and career goals, while schools can confidently discover talent that aligns with their values and needs. Beyond hiring, Teachinghood is committed to building a supportive and thriving educational community. We aim to empower teachers, assist schools, and ultimately improve learning environments across India. By bridging gaps, sharing resources, and fostering meaningful connections, we're helping every educator and every institution move closer to excellence.



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